Who This Book Is For

This book is for programmers looking to build and deploy web-based applications. This includes application programmers who are new to Rails (and perhaps even new to Ruby) as well as those who are familiar with the basics but want a more in-depth understanding of Rails.

We presume some familiarity with HTML, Cascading Style Sheets (CSS), and JavaScript—in other words, the ability to view source on web pages. You needn't be an expert on these subjects; the most you'll be expected to do is copy and paste material from the book, all of which can be downloaded.

The focus of this book is on the features and choices made by the Rails core team. More specifically, this book is for *users* of the Rails framework—people who tend to be more concerned about what Rails does, as opposed to how it does it or how to change Rails to suit their needs. Examples of topics not covered in this book include the following:

- Turbo Drive[7] is a way to load pages more quickly by just loading markup. If you want to know more about how Rails makes your pages load faster, follow that link. But should you instead be content with the knowledge that Rails makes pages load fast and not need to know more, that's OK too.

- Propshaft[8] replaces Sprockets[9] as the asset pipeline for Rails. It is responsible for adding hashes to the end of asset URLs. If you're interested in how Rails makes sure that your assets are always up-to-date, you can follow that link. But if you're happy with the knowledge that Rails makes sure your assets are always up-to-date and don't need to know more, that's OK too.